



Serves IT Right

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As a growing computerised enterprise, whatever its size may be, sooner or later, the need for a server will be felt. Countless tasks, such as sharing files and resources, taking regular backups of your work, maintaining a repository of your digitised documents and other essential data and so on, can be done effectively and efficiently with a server in place.

But, can't a workstation double up as a server? A workstation PC with enough processing power and memory *may* suffice, but a server is more than computing power. There are other aspects to this beast.

For example, regular PCs are based on components with a short shelf-life as compared to those used in servers. So, if your server uses a motherboard meant for a desktop PC, you will have no option but to upgrade if something hap-

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pens to it. And an upgrade is by no means a simple task: older software such as the OS, a client database, your sales figures, etc., would require migration, re-installation or optimisation—which is a big waste of time and money.

However, this won't be the case with a proper server, since server vendors ensure that spare parts are made available for a longer duration, even if they come at a price.

In a growing business, greater demands are placed on office infrastructure, and resources are pulled to their limit—demanding induction of new servers or upgrading existing ones. Investing in a scalable server will save a lot of trouble later on.

A server needs to strike a balance between performance, reliability, scalability and price.

State Of The Market

The words *server* and *expensive* were synonymous not long ago, but this has changed significantly. Basic servers today—deployed as file servers,